THOMISM

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shire, situated on the river Swale, sixteen miles north-west of York. It sends two members to parliament.

THIRST, an uneasy sensation, arising from a deficiency in the saliva to moisten the inward parts of the mouth; hence arises a strong desire for drink: it is a symptom generally attending feverish disorders.

THISTLE, in botany. See CARDUUS.

Order of the THISTLE, *or of St* ANDREW, a military order of knighthood in Scotland, the rise and institution whereof is variously related by different authors. Lesley, bishop of Ross, reports, that the night before the battle between Athelstan king of Northumberland, and Hungus king of the Picts, a bright cross, in form of that whereon St Andrew (the tutelar saint of Scotland) suffered martyrdom, appeared to Hungus; who having gained the victory, ever after bore the figure of that cross on his banners. Others assert, that Achaius king of Scotland first instituted this order, after having made the famous league offensive and defensive with Charlemagne king of France. But although the thistle had been acknowledged as the symbol of the kingdom of Scotland from the reign of Achaius, yet some refer the beginning of this order to Charles VII. of France. Others place the foundation of it as low as the year 1500.

The chief and principal enfign is a gold collar composed of thistles and sprigs of rue interlinked with amulets of gold, having pendent thereunto the image of St Andrew with his cross, and the motto, NEMO ME IMPUNE LACESSET.

The ordinary or common enfign worn by the knights, is a star of four silver points, and over them a green circle, bordered and lettered with gold, containing the said motto, and in the centre is a thistle proper; all which is embroidered on their left breast, and worn with the collar, with a green ribband over the left shoulder, and brought under the right arm; pendent thereto is the image of St Andrew, with his cross, in a purple robe, within an oval of gold enamelled vert, with the former motto: but sometimes they wear, encircled in the same manner, a thistle crowned.

About the time of the reformation, this order was dropped, till James II. of England resumed it, by creating eight knights: however, the revolution unsettled it again, and it lay neglected till queen Anne, in 1703, restored it to the primitive design, of twelve knights of St Andrew.

THLASPI, in botany, a genus of the tetradynamia siliculosa class. The pod is emarginated, heart-shaped, containing many seeds. There are ten species, six of them natives of Britain, *viz.* the campestre, or mithridate; the arvense, or treacle-mustard; the perfoliatum, or perfoliate treacle-mustard; the furtum, or perennial mithridate mustard; the montanum, or mountain mithridate-mustard; and the bursa pastoris, or shepherd's purse.

THOMÆANS, THOMISTS, or *Christians of St* THOMAS, a people of the East-Indies, who, according to the tradition, received the Gospel from St Thomas. Upon the arrival of the Portuguese at Calicut, in their first voyage to the Indies, they met with ancient Christians, who pretended to be defeended from those converted by St Thomas. The Thomæans being informed of a new people arrived among them, who bore a particular veneration for the cross, sent embassadors to them, to make an alliance with them, and to follicit their assistance against the Gentile princes, by whom they were greatly oppressed. A mixture of opinions, with a total interruption of pastors, sometimes for several years together, occasioned that horrible chaos their religion was in at the arrival of the Portuguese; for a specimen whereof we shall add their manner of celebrating the eucharist: Over their altar was a kind of gallery; and while the priest was saying the beginning of the office below, a cake of flour of rice was frying in oil, or butter, above; when enough, the cake was let down in a basket upon the altar, where the priest consecrated it: as to the other species, for wine they used a kind of brandy or arrack, variously prepared in that country. Nor was their ordination much more regular; the archdeacon, who was sometimes more respected than the bishop himself, frequently ordained priests: their other abuses were infinite. The Portuguese, for these two last centuries, have laboured the reformation of this church, and have employed both the ecclesiastic and secular power therein: for this end they have called the Thomæan bishops to the council at Goa, have instructed, charged them, *&c.* and even sent them for instruction to Portugal and Rome; but finding that they were still apt to relapse at their return, and that no good was like to be done with them, they resolved to exclude them once for all, and to appoint an European bishop in their room. These proceedings have rendered the Portuguese infinitely odious to the Thomæans.

St THOMAS, a city of the hither India, on the coast of Coromandel, three miles south of Fort St George; subject to the Portuguese.

St THOMAS is also an island in the Atlantic ocean, situated under the equator, in 8° E. long.

St THOMAS is also a town of Guiana, in South America, situated on the river Oronoko; subject to Spain.

St. THOMAS'S DAY, a festival of the Christian church, observed on Dec. 21. in commemoration of St Thomas the apostle.

St THOMAS *of Canterbury's day*, a festival of the Romish church, observed on Dec. 29. in memory of Thomas Becket archbishop of Canterbury, who was murdered, or, as the Romanists say, martyred, in the reign of king Henry II.

THOMISM, the doctrine of St Thomas Aquinas, and his followers the Thomists, chiefly with regard to predestination and grace. There is some doubt what the true genuine thomism is, but there are authors who distinguish the thomism of St Thomas from that of the dominicans. Others again make thomism no other than a kind of jansenism disguised: but jansenism, it is known, has been condemned by the popes, which pure thomism never was: in effect, the writings of Alvarez and Lemos, who were appointed by their order to lay down and defend, before the holy see, the dogmata of their school, have since been reputed the rule of pure thomism.

THOMISTS, a sect of school-divines, who maintain thomism. See the preceding article.

THORACIC DUCT. See ANATOMY, p. 282.

THORAX, in anatomy. See ANATOMY, p. 277.

THORN, a city of Poland, in the province of regal Prussia, situated on the river Vistula: E. long. 19°, and N. lat. 52° 40'.

THORN-

Figure 1: *
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